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TOP INVESTOR

Sequoia keeps the top spot in our generative AI investor rankings

By [Jacob Robbins](#)

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Generative AI has commanded the attention of the entire venture ecosystem, and who's writing the checks and keeping the boom going has been in constant flux.

In Q1 2025, AI and machine learning accounted for [58% of all global VC deal value](#); in the US and Canada, the vertical accounted for more than 70% of all VC spending.

The competition among VCs is intensifying as fear over missing out continues to drive record dealmaking. Here is an updated list of the 10 most active VC investors in generative AI since 2019, according to PitchBook data.

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1. Sequoia (Rank unchanged)

Menlo Park, CA

SEQUOIA 

Sequoia remains in the top spot as the most active investor in AI and machine learning since 2023. One of the largest VC firms in the world, its AI portfolio is a smattering of large language model providers like OpenAI and Elon Musk's xAI, mixed with application companies like Glean, an enterprise AI search platform, and Safe Superintelligence, an AI safety startup founded by OpenAI co-founder Ilya Sutskever.

VC INVESTMENTS

84

EXITS

7

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

\$16M

SELECT PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

OpenAI, xAI, Glean, Safe Superintelligence



2. Gaingels (Previous rank: 8)

Burlington, VT

Jumping up from the back of the list, Gaingels has made most of its AI bets in the infrastructure layer and application space. Adbridge, an AI medical transcription startup, is reportedly doubling its valuation with new funding, while Weights and Biases, which offers an AI developer platform, was acquired by CoreWeave in May for over \$1.7 billion.

VC INVESTMENTS

76

EXITS

6

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

\$10M

SELECT PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

Adbridge, Cerebras Systems, People.ai, Figure

3. Pioneer Fund (Rank unchanged)

San Francisco

 **PIONEER**

Pioneer Fund's continued presence is a testament to how much generative AI has permeated Y Combinator's recent cohorts. The firm only invests—and is comprised entirely of—YC alumni. Its portfolio includes Moonvalley, an AI video creation startup that followed up its \$70 million seed round with \$53 million in new funding in May.

VC INVESTMENTS

74

EXITS

2

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

\$3.6M

SELECT PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

Moonvalley, Agentic Labs, Model ML

4. Andreessen Horowitz (Previous rank: 2)

Menlo Park, CA

Andreessen Horowitz made a pledge to back as many AI startups as it could, but it appears to have fallen behind. What it may have lost in quantity it is certainly making up for with quality, going all in on some of the biggest, most high-profile AI startups in the world. The firm has backed OpenAI, rival xAI, and French company Mistral. Its portfolio also includes Cursor, the AI coding startup that has been doubling its valuation every eight weeks since August.

VC INVESTMENTS

73

EXITS

4

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

\$30M

SELECT PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

Mistral, Cursor, OpenAI

5. Khosla Ventures (Rank unchanged)

Menlo Park, CA

One of the first VC backers of OpenAI, Khosla Ventures has been a huge champion of AI, particularly when it comes to medicine. Founder Vinod Khosla has written at length about how AI will replace traditional doctors, and the firm has backed Curai Health, an AI-powered primary care platform startup.

VC INVESTMENTS

57

EXITS

3

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

\$15M

SELECT PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

OpenAI, Curai Health, Replika

6. Soma Capital (Previous rank: 4)

San Francisco

Focusing on developer tools and applications, Soma Capital backs startups across all verticals and stages. Its portfolio includes Artisan AI, a workflow automation startup using a controversial marketing campaign with the tagline "stop hiring humans." Soma is also an investor in Rippling and Deel, which are locked in a bitter lawsuit over corporate espionage.

VC INVESTMENTS

55

EXITS

5

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

\$4.2M

SELECT PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

Artisan, Imbue, Moonvalley

7. Alumni Ventures (Previous rank: 6)

Manchester, NH

Investing in the large language model developer Cohere and the GPU cloud computing startup Lamba, Alumni Ventures operates university-specific funds across America and has an AI and machine learning-focused fund. Alumni has also

invested in several AI chip companies, such as Groq and Enfabrica.

VC INVESTMENTS

54

EXITS

3

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

\$11.7M

SELECT PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

Cohere, Lambda, Groq

8. General Catalyst (New entrant)



San Francisco

General Catalyst leapt onto this list by investing in a range of AI startups, from model developers to enterprise application makers. Its portfolio includes the AI-assisted coding platform provider Windsurf, which is reportedly in talks to be acquired by OpenAI for over \$3 billion.

VC INVESTMENTS

41

EXITS

7

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

\$26.3M

SELECT PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

Windsurf, Glean, Mistrial, Hive

9. Lightspeed (Previous rank: 7)



Menlo Park, CA

Lightspeed's portfolio includes some of the most prominent AI startups in the space, including Anthropic and xAI. The firm has also invested in Inworld AI, a developer of gaming-specific LLMs, and Stability AI, creator of the video generation model Stable Diffusion.

VC INVESTMENTS

40

EXITS

2

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

\$32.4M

SELECT PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

Anthropic, Granola, xAI

10. Antler (New entrant)



Singapore

Antler focuses exclusively on early-stage startups across the globe and is a new entrant on our most active AI investors list. The firm has backed AI software startups like 913.ai, an AI agents development specialist, and AI property management assistant startup Aiden.

VC INVESTMENTS

40

EXITS

-

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

\$0.2M

SELECT PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

Zealth-ai, Omma, Banqora

Methodology: Lists of most active investors are based on a tally of relevant deal types as defined by PitchBook. These deal types align with existing PitchBook report methodologies, which can be found [here](#). This list is limited to VC investors and excludes angel groups, accelerators, incubators and growth investors, among other investor types.

Featured image by Jenna O'Malley/PitchBook News

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About [Jacob Robbins](#)

Reporter Jacob Robbins covers artificial intelligence and the venture capital ecosystem for PitchBook. Based in Seattle, Jacob is originally from Massachusetts and holds dual degrees in political science and cinema studies from the American University. His work has previously appeared in Air Mail and Business Insider.

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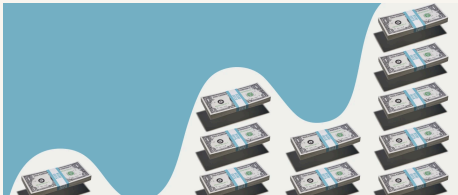
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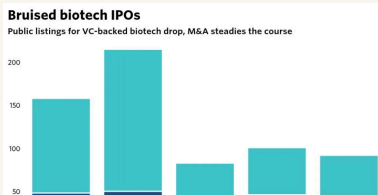
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